

Session 3 — Data Collection Write-up

Eurovision Career-Bump Effect, 2015–2025 · Marta Prandin + teammate · Albert School, Data Projects

This document contains the three written deliverables Session 3 asks for (data dictionary, ethics & source note, quality issues). The fourth deliverable — the raw data — lives in our GitHub repo at `data/raw/eurovision_artist_bios_YYYYMMDD_HHMMSS.csv` (and `.parquet`). Code is in `notebooks/02_scraping.ipynb` in the same repo.

1. Data dictionary — scraped artist bios

One row per unique top-10 finisher (99 artists across 2015–2025; 2020 skipped). Joins with the API discography on the artist column. Column names from the Wikipedia infobox.

Column	Type	Example	Description
artist	string	Loreen	Performer's name (joins with API data).
earliest_eurovision_year	int	2023	First year this artist placed in the top 10 (some appear twice).
earliest_eurovision_rank	int	1	Their finish position that year (1 = winner).
wikipedia_slug	string	Loreen_(singer)	URL-path used to fetch the article.
wikipedia_url	string	https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Loreen_(singer)	Full article URL.
scraped_at	string	2026-05-19T15:42:11	ISO timestamp of fetch.
born	string	16 October 1983 (age 41) Stockholm, Sweden	Raw birth field — date + place mixed.
origin	string	Stockholm, Sweden	Free-text origin location.
genres	string	Pop, dance, electronic	Comma-separated genre tags.
occupation	string	Singer, songwriter	Comma-separated roles.
years_active	string	2004–present	Free-text career span.
labels	string	Universal, Warner	Comma-separated record labels.

2. Ethics & source note

Source.

- English Wikipedia artist articles, e.g. [https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Loreen_\(singer\)](https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Loreen_(singer)).
- 99 unique top-10 finishers, derived from Wikipedia year pages (2015–2025, excluding 2020).

robots.txt verdict.

- <https://en.wikipedia.org/robots.txt> allows generic crawlers on `/wiki/` article paths.
- Wikipedia explicitly encourages programmatic access for research and academic use, provided rates are reasonable.

Rate limit applied.

- 99 requests with `time.sleep(1)` between them — about 2 minutes total. Far below any abuse threshold.
- `timeout=15` seconds per request so a hanging response does not freeze the kernel.
- Descriptive User-Agent: `AlbertSchool-DataProject/1.0 (marta.prandin@student.example.com)`.

Terms of Service & licensing.

- Wikipedia text is CC-BY-SA 3.0. We attribute Wikipedia contributors in the final report.
- Non-commercial student academic project. No redistribution.

Personal-data / GDPR audit.

- The data is about public-figure performers. Born dates and origins are publicly published biographical facts about artists in their professional capacity.
- No emails, phone numbers, home addresses, or photos of private individuals are collected.

3. Quality issues we already spotted

These are problems noticed while scraping. We will fix them in Session 4 (cleaning).

Issue 1 — Some artist URLs miss or hit the wrong Wikipedia page.

Several 2024–2025 finalists do not yet have English Wikipedia articles, and some artists with very common names (e.g. JJ, KAJ) needed disambiguation suffixes like JJ_(Austrian_singer). The notebook prints every artist it could not scrape; we expect ~90 successful out of 99 attempted. Session 4 fix: review the failure list, manually find correct slugs where they exist, and document the rest as known gaps.

Issue 2 — Infobox fields are free-text strings, not structured data.

years_active comes back as "2015–present", "2012–2016, 2019–present", or sometimes blank. Session 4 fix: regex out the first 4-digit year as career_start_year and treat the rest as missing.

Issue 3 — Genres is a noisy comma-separated string.

Examples: "Pop, dance-pop, R&B", "Pop", "Electronic (synth-pop), house". Session 4 fix: split on comma, strip sub-genres in parentheses, normalise to lowercase, and possibly cluster the long tail.

Issue 4 — Born mixes a date and a place.

Example: "16 October 1983 (age 41) Stockholm, Sweden". Session 4 fix: split with a regex into birth_date (parse with dateparser) and birth_place. Use this for a "how long had they been active before Eurovision?" feature.

Issue 5 — Two artists appear twice in the dataset.

Sergey Lazarev placed in 2016 and 2019; Mahmood placed in 2019 and 2022. We dedupe by Wikipedia slug for the bio scrape, but the analysis must decide whether to count the earlier or later Eurovision appearance as their "event".

Repository pointers

- Code: notebooks/01_api_collection.ipynb (Session 2) and notebooks/02_scraping.ipynb (Session 3).
- Raw data: data/raw/musicbrainz_raw_*.json, eurovision_artists_discography_*.csv, eurovision_artist_bios_*. {csv,parquet}.
- Project canvas (Session 1, updated for the career-bump pivot): in our repo root.